

Pricing Should Follow Buyer Economics, Not a Flat Competitor Average

Pricing and monetization case built on the same market logic and buyer segmentation from Flagship Case 02.

\$49 / \$149 / \$399

+35-45% ARPU

3 segments

4 validation tracks

Work Type

Self-initiated decision sample

\$49 / \$149 / \$399

proposed price ladder

+35-45%

projected ARPU uplift

3

target customer segments

4

validation tracks

The pricing problem is that one offer is trying to serve unlike buyers

The same product is being sold to customers with different workflow depth, integration needs, and governance expectations.

Key points

- Small teams face too much friction for the value they need.
- Growing teams lack a clear mid-tier that matches collaboration and integration needs.
- Control-heavy buyers see too little structure and too few governance signals.

Current-state diagnosis

A flat price blurs segment logic, weakens expansion revenue, and creates unnecessary churn.

The pricing ladder should follow the value ladder

Customers pay most for labor saved, workflow fit, and governance when control matters.

Rank	Value driver	Why it matters	WTP signal
1	Time saved	Reduces labor and turnaround friction	Highest
2	Integration depth	Embeds the product in real workflows	High
3	Collaboration	Supports multi-user coordination	Medium-High
4	Governance	Matters more as control burden rises	Medium-High
5	Support	Secondary to workflow value	Low-Medium

This mirrors the buyer logic already established in the commercial-intelligence case.

The product should be packaged around three customer maturities

Each segment buys a different combination of relief, workflow depth, and control.

Segment	Buyer logic	Illustrative WTP	Packaging implication
Small teams	Need lean workflow relief	\$40-60	Starter tier
Growing teams	Need integration and collaboration	\$120-180	Professional tier
Control-heavy teams	Need governance and admin control	\$300-500	Business tier

Segmentation is what turns pricing from arithmetic into strategy.

Packaging rules should reinforce the upgrade path instead of creating escape hatches

The commercial discipline is not just the price points. It is the way billing, trials, and add-ons support migration through the ladder.

Key points

- Default annual billing can support capture without hiding monthly flexibility.
- Add-ons should create a bridge to the next tier, not a substitute for moving up.
- Governance and admin depth should remain premium anchors for larger buyers.

System design principle

A clean pricing system feels fair because the fences reflect maturity and operating complexity.

The recommended tier ladder creates cleaner upgrade fences

The pricing story becomes easier to sell when each tier matches a distinct maturity level.

Tier	Price	Target	Feature logic	Upgrade fence
Starter	\$49	1-5 users	Core workflow, limited integrations	Move up for collaboration/connectivity
Professional	\$149	6-25 users	All integrations, collaboration	Move up for control/admin
Business	\$399	26-100 users	Compliance, admin, custom integrations	Top tier

The ladder is designed to improve both capture and clarity.

Rollout should happen in four validation waves

Pricing becomes credible when it is paired with tests, migration logic, and explicit decision rules.

Wave	Test	Primary metric	Decision rule
1	Pricing-page test	Entry conversion	Keep if conversion remains stable
2	Trial routing	Activation by segment	Keep if fit improves by segment
3	Controlled migration	Expansion + downgrade	Scale if retention improves
4	Enterprise interviews	Governance value perception	Adjust Business tier if unclear

The validation plan prevents a pricing reset from becoming an uncontrolled revenue experiment.

Good pricing work ends with tests and guardrails, not just a price table

This case shows Santiago can convert market logic into packaging logic and a validation plan rather than stopping at descriptive research.

Takeaways

- Use pricing-page tests, customer pilots, and call feedback before full rollout.
- For recruiter review or project discussion, email santiago.garces.blevine@gmail.com. Include the role or problem, timeline, and expected deliverable format.

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Workflow Execution

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Flagship Case 03 | Pricing and Monetization